

THE PLATES of DANA

Dana and Shannon Gorbahn Family - Christmas & History Letter - 2024



Dear Family and Friends,

This Christmas, we hope your hearts are wrapped in the warmth of love, your homes are filled with laughter, and joy touches every moment you share. Our cherished tradition of these annual letters has become a little record of our family's journey, which we've lovingly dubbed the *Plates of Dana*. As we reflect on another year, we're reminded how grateful we are for the love, memories, and connections we share with each of you. May this season bring you peace, unforgettable moments, and the magic that only Christmas can bring. Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year!



Jadyn: Hi friends and family! I hope everyone had a great year full of good times and special memories! Well so we moved to Calgary at the end of June so I got to enjoy the first part of the year in Smithers. I made sure to take everything in cause I knew how much I was gonna miss it. And man do I ever. My friends, my apartment, walking my dog in peace, all the views and spots. I miss it a lot. But I am very happy here! I landed a job nannying a baby who was 4 months old when I started and the baby and his parents are seriously awesome! I always thought I was ready for kids but after having a few rough shifts. I am so glad I get to go home at the end of day.



Defs not ready yet. I didn't go on many trips this year because of the move but I did get to visit my friend Megan from Victoria in September and my friend Mikayla from Smithers just visited me here in



Calgary a couple weeks ago, felt so good to be with my friends again. This thanksgiving we had a family reunion for my mom's side, it was such a blessing getting to see everyone and be all together!! It's meant so much to be so close to so much family now. It went from me, my mom and dad to me, my mom, my dad, Oma, Kai, Kaleb, Lauren and

Sarah?!?!?!?! I do always feel like we're missing someone but thankfully Taaron does come to visit us. I've also LOVED having the family come here to visit Oma!! Merry Christmas and Happy New Year, I love you all and wish you all the absolute best for this coming year!!



Kaleb: This Christmas feels extra special for me. Lauren and I are overjoyed to spend it with our beautiful daughter, Sarah. Becoming parents has been the greatest blessing. No matter how our days unfold, every night as we lie in bed, we can't help but feel deeply grateful for our little girl.

This year also marks a first in a long time, I get to see my family on Christmas Day, which makes this holiday even more meaningful.

2024 has been a year of incredible change. I seem to say that every year, but this time it's especially true. In February, we welcomed Sarah Grace Gorbahn into our lives, and she's brought us so much happiness. Professionally, I started the year as the Head Teaching Professional at Lynx Ridge Golf Club, a role that has been an absolute joy. Coaching others is incredibly rewarding. By June, my parents, Jadyn, and Oma had moved to Calgary, making weekly Sunday dinners with them a highlight of our week.

July brought us exciting news, our family of three is growing! Sarah will become a big sister in April, as we're expecting another baby girl. Lauren is doing wonderfully, and our little one appears to be growing healthy in Lauren's tummy.



On the career front, I'm thrilled to share that I've been promoted to Head Professional at Lynx Ridge. It's been amazing to see how quickly my career has progressed, and I feel proud and grateful for the opportunities I've had.

As we look ahead to 2025, I'm eager to embrace the changes it will bring: a full house, a new job, and a life filled with love and adventure. Wishing you all a joyful Christmas and an even better New Year!





Taaron: Hello again, my wonderful family! I hope your 2024 was as amazing as mine. I'm so blessed to have enjoyed such an excellent year!

Work has been fantastic as always! Growing, thriving, and always busy — which is exactly the way I like it. Working remote gives me lots of flexibility with things like travel. In particular, this year I was able to spend a wonderful vacation with my family to the Gulf of Mexico as well as an extended trip to Arizona where I got to spend time with family, work from my laptop for a week, and then enjoy another week with my friends which included a Segway tour, a visit to the Grand Canyon, and a night in Vegas to watch Cirque Du Soleil!

With my family all living in Calgary now, I've also been able to find a few chances (and super cheap flights) to visit everyone regularly. It's been so wonderful and I'm looking forward to many more trips to see them in 2025!

Over this past year, I've also been spending many evenings immersed in the local comedy scene, particularly learning how to perform improv comedy. It's been such a wonderful experience and I've met so many new and amazing friends. This culminated in me auditioning and getting accepted in a masterclass troop and performing several shows!

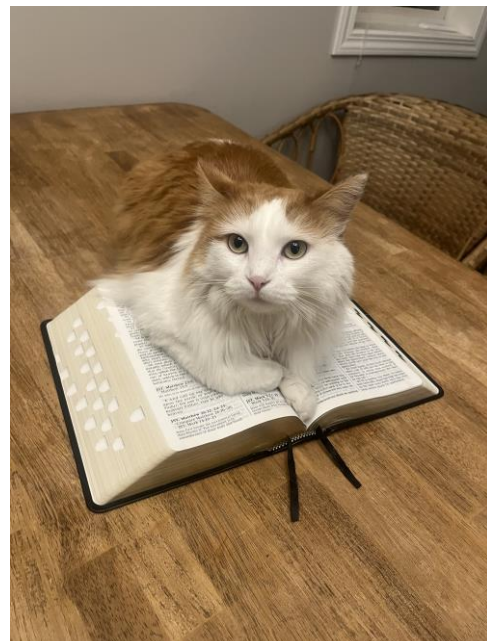
I've also dived back into my old filmmaking passions and took on the task of directing a comedy special / documentary for a local comedian. It's become such a rewarding creative project and I can't wait to share it with the world! It's being released on YouTube in early January and I already have lots of ideas for future creative endeavours to tackle in the evenings and weekends.

Here's to a wonderful 2025! Until next time...

- Taaron



Kai: Merry Christmas everyone. It has been a wonderful year for me. I can't believe I've been in Calgary for over six years. My cat, Kali, is now five years old. Time flies. This year was a bit of a change up - with a new room mate (Jadyn!) and my parents living in Airdrie. It's been so nice to have family around and to be able to see Oma. I'm so grateful for all the blessings in my life. I hope you all have a wonderful Christmas and a good New Year, Kai





Shannon: Merry Christmas everyone. We have had such busy wonderful year of change. Closing my yoga studio was the beginning of the steps to move to Airdrie. What a chore liquidating packing up and of settling in our new home. So glad we did, I just love being closer to most of our kids and amazing little grand daughter. Our church ward has been wonderful and I have made a few friends. I have been called to serve in the primary. I am keeping busy nannying for a couple families part time, it's nice to be needed. We still managed to go on a big trip to Paris, Barcelona and a long cruise to Florida and wonderful family came to stay with Irene while we were away. We hosted thanksgiving reunion for my side of the family it was wonderful to see everyone. Feeling incredibly blessed. May you all have a blessed New Year.



Dana: Another year has gone by and this has been quite the change for me! We took a quick trip to Arizona to get some sun but we were also excited to see our new master bathroom renovations. Disappointment was immediately felt as the first night upon arriving, I was showering and the tile floor beneath me started to crumble and fall through the floor! I spent that week with the contractor building a new base and re-tiling it. Later in the year, when we back down, we found that the threshold was moving and cracking from the first work that was done. We hired a new contractor to replace everything! But on another follow up trip down, we found the drain plugged from



construction and the floor pitch was pooling all over the large base. We had to have him come back and tear it out again. I had to have him come back a couple of times, including a trip down in May when Marinda (with Jake, Hannah, and Kyla) joined us and we were able to watch my nephew Micah finish his college career pitching for the Utah Utes. We finally got it done at the end of September when I went down with Oliver to get it ready for the rental





season. On that trip, I got to drive my sister Marinda home from our place as she was up visiting mom. We also went on a family cruise out of Houston Texas with all of the kids, except Kaleb and Lauren (because of the pregnancy). It was too bad that we didn't have them there with us. We had a wonderful time. The rest of the early part of the year had me in the mode of trying to get things taken care of for

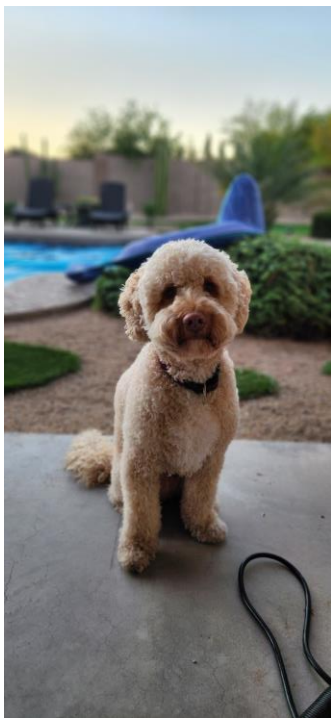
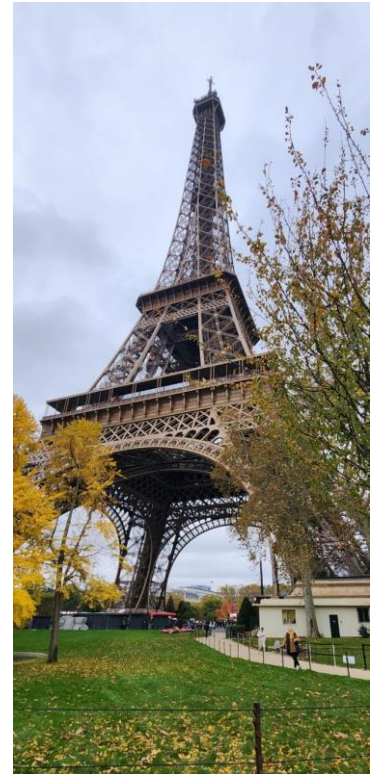
a move to Alberta. This meant that we need to sell some real estate and my business. Some work was needed but we were eventually able to sell a bunch of it, including the vendor financing for one of our commercial buildings (the Gone Hollywood Video building). I also sold my business to the company that I originally started out in my career. I feel really good about it but will/have missed the relationships with the individuals that we served, their families, the staff, and the community. We still own a couple of the group homes and have long term leases set up for them. There was a lot of work to get my staff set up with the new company. Six months later, and I am still working on data transfer to various organizations. I continued to officiate basketball and really enjoyed it. I went to provincials again and was selected to be the crew chief for the bronze medal match – and then after the game they had a little ceremony to award me with the 2024 BCBOA Bob Hall Award of Merit – for Mentoring, Recruitment, Officiating, Education, Administration, and Leadership in basketball officiating. After basketball provincials, I went to Alberta to continue our search for a home. Shannon had gone earlier and hadn't found us anything to our likings. I didn't have a lot of time but the last house on the last day of house shopping, we found the right house for us. It is just a few minutes down the street from Kaleb, Lauren and Sarah (Noodle). Shannon agreed that she liked it and we purchased it. We moved at the end of June and took possession in July. We had to sell a ton of our stuff in Smithers because we couldn't move all of it and no longer had the various buildings to store the stuff. When we moved in, our new ward had a crew of people there helping us get in. We were so welcomed by our new friends at church. The next day after getting into the house, we started renovations for the den



and half bath to be converted into a bedroom and full bathroom for my mom to join us. This would allow her not to have to use any stairs. Ten days later we had a little family reunion in Abbotsford and then moved mom out of her home and Veronica brought mom over to Alberta. It was a tough time for mom to have to part with so many things that she cherished over the years. We are so greatly blessed to have mom (Oma) in our home and so much appreciate the special spirit she has. The summer was filled with getting us moved in, golfing, golf marshalling for Kaleb's golf course and business sale tie ups. We started our basement renovations at the beginning of September which included a bedroom/office,



bathroom, family room, storage, and a golf simulator space. The contractor said that it would be about 5 weeks but it turned out to be 13 weeks! Ridiculous! A trip to AZ as earlier mentioned with Oliver September. I got called to be in the Young Mens (Teacher Quorum). Having Shannon's family for Thanksgiving was so great! It was so wonderful to have them here and to renew the relationships! Shannon and I went on an epic trip to Paris for a few days; a train to Barcelona for a couple of days; and then a 13-night Transatlantic cruise. Our stops were Lisbon, Ponta Delgada (Azores), Bermuda and then Fort Lauderdale. This time was wonderful but we really had way too many days at sea. One stretch including 5 days in a row. I gained 14 pounds on the trip! Did I really eat that much? We were so grateful for Mary Jane and Hart and Heidi for taking care of Oma; which allowed us to do this. Just prior to us leaving – mom had a little fall and was in such bad shape. We were very worried for her. It really took out a lot of her mobility; but amazing, after a few visits with her chiropractor, she bounced back a bit but she is really exhausted and is struggling to feel productive. She is having ongoing tests for things that she is struggling with – but fortunately, nothing has been serious. She gets fairly regular visits from her children and grandchildren which she gets a lot of energy and strength from (even though there is a bit a decline in energy afterwards). The rest of the year was getting ready for Christmas. We have just been fortunate enough this past week in December to have our little Noodle stay with us for a week while her parents went on a well deserved sun destine vacation. It has been so special. She is just adorable and the most perfect little angel!! We will be getting Veronica and Brad to stay with us over Christmas as they visit Oma. We will have everyone here except Taaron. He had made more trips to us after our move than he had for like 8 years in Smithers. We will miss him during our Christmas week but know that he is in our hearts. You will all be in our hearts and we wish you the most blessed and fantastic season!



Oma:



Christmas 2024:
Irene R. Gorbahn

The most interesting and blessed event in this past year for me was my loving and selfless acceptance of Dana and Shannon into their household last August. They have been absolutely wonderful. I owe them greatly and adore my nearby gr. grandchild Sara. I still miss my Ahtsford home and many friends, but appreciate having my own phone.

My love and blessings go out to each of you. You mean the world to me. Remember your Savior, and be led by the Spirit throughout this season and all year.

Your mother, grandmother and gr. grandmother
Oma G.

We love you all and wish the very best for you, always! With all our Love - Dana, Shannon, Kai, Taaron, Kaleb, Lauren, Jaddy, Louie, Oliver, Kali, and OMA!